

Watersheds of France

Marie Gaiffe

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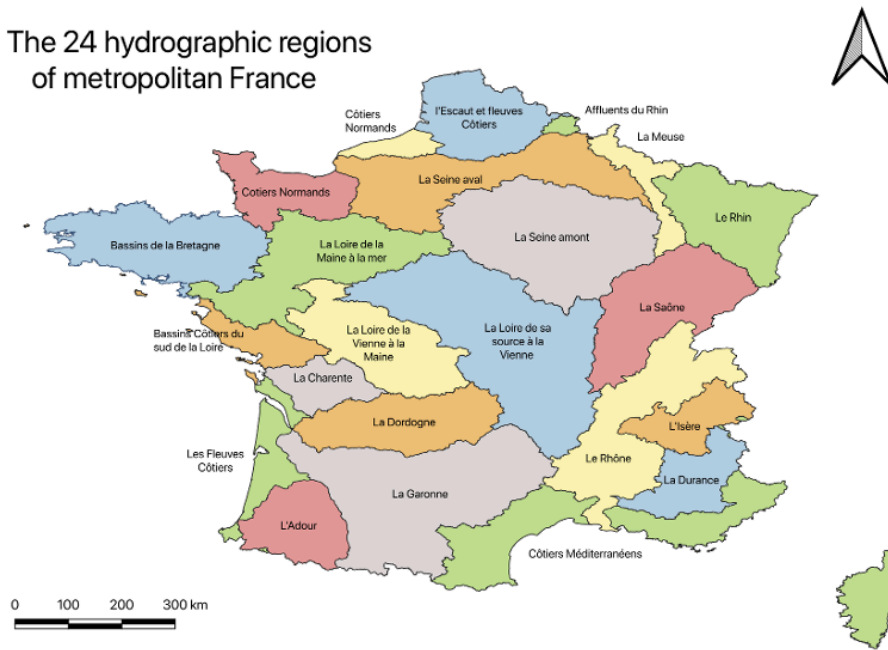
The term **watershed** describes an area of land that drains downslope to the lowest point. Water moves through a network of drainage pathways, both underground and on the surface. These pathways converge into streams and rivers, which become progressively larger as the water moves on downstream, eventually reaching the ocean.

hydrologic region is one of the smaller units, with fixed boundaries, into which large tracts of country, sharing a common climate and geologic and topographical structure, are divided for the purpose

*of collecting hydrologic data on the same basis
from year to year, thus facilitating historical analysis.*

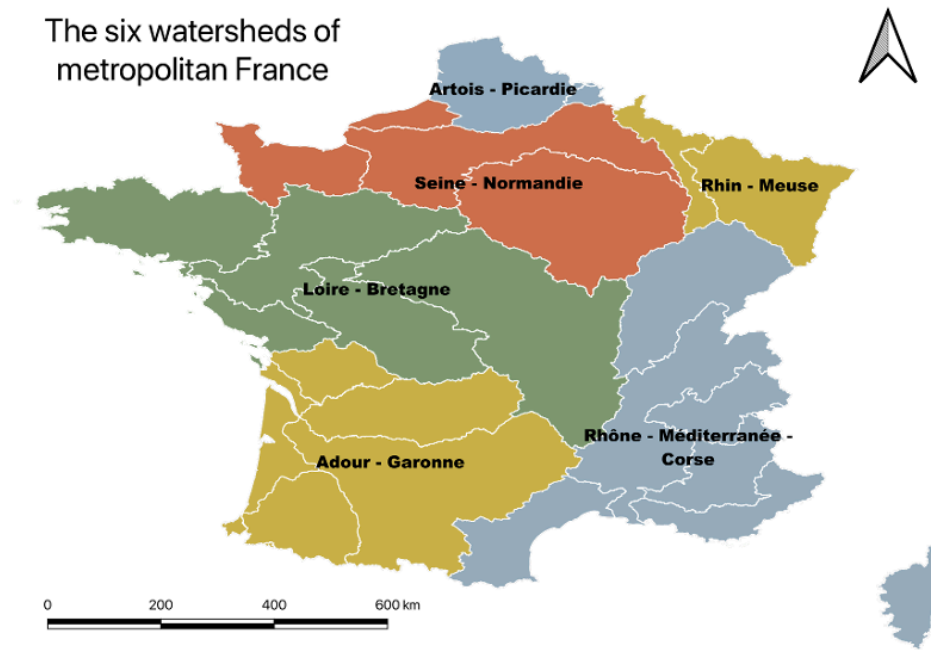
*Metropolitan France is composed of 24 hydrologic
region*

The 24 hydrographic regions
of metropolitan France



Then Metropolitan France is composed of 6 drainage basin of
variable size :

The six watersheds of metropolitan France



Drainage Basin	Area (km ²)	% of total area	Length of streams (km)
Rhin - Meuse	31 437	6 %	30 058
Artois - Picardie	19 920	4 %	12 265
Seine - Normandie	94 881	17 %	55 083
Loire - Bretagne	156 870	28 %	135 493
Adour - Garonne	118 040	21 %	119 966
Rhône - Méditerranée - Corse	130 660	24 %	152 427

Finally, we can have an overview of in which watershed the main streams and rivers are :

Streams and rivers of
each watersheds of
France

